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The twenty-minute city. Hills, sea and vines on the doorstep.

Adelaide is the Australian capital where a tertiary career and a home you can genuinely plan to buy still sit side by side. The Adelaide Hills are twenty minutes from the wards, the beach is at the end of the tram line, and some of the world's best-known wine country is within the hour. It is elegant, unhurried and remarkably easy to live in.

~1.4M

people in Greater
Adelaide

20 min

from the city to the
Adelaide Hills

~15 min

from the airport to the
city centre

No tolls

on any road in the state

IN THIS GUIDE

01 Why clinicians choose Adelaide

02 A planned city between the hills and the sea

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14 Your Ethicare journey

Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Adelaide

Clinicians usually come to Adelaide for the balance: genuine tertiary medicine in a capital city where the commute is short, the weekends are glorious and a salary goes noticeably further.



If you are looking for the buzz of an enormous city, Adelaide may not be it. If you are drawn to short commutes, a home you can plan to own and the hills, the sea and the vines all within the hour, it could be a wonderful choice.

Around 1.4 million people live in Greater Adelaide, on a city grid laid out in 1836 and ringed completely by parkland. The River Torrens runs through the middle, the Adelaide Hills rise behind the city, and around thirty kilometres of white-sand beach run down the western edge, with a tram to the middle of them.

For clinicians the draw is a health system that is genuinely large for the city's size: three metropolitan health networks, a statewide women's and children's service, and one of the newest hospital-and-research precincts in the southern hemisphere on the city's western boulevard. It is a system you can get to know personally within a year, and many people tell us that is exactly what they love about it.

Adelaide is also the most affordable of the mainland capitals. Pay in public health follows state agreements and sits broadly in the national range, so the point is not that you earn more here. It is that the same career buys noticeably more life: more home, more time and more weekends.

No tolls

anywhere in South
Australia

and among the shortest
commutes of any mainland
capital

< 1 hr

to the Barossa, McLaren
Vale or the Hills

a cellar-door lunch is an
ordinary Saturday

Regional

for skilled migration

the whole state, Adelaide
included

WHAT YOU GAIN

Time back every day

Most of Adelaide is twenty-odd minutes from most of the rest of it. The hours you are not spending in traffic quietly add up to a better life.

A home within reach

Housing costs sit well below Sydney and Melbourne, so buying a family home is a realistic mid-career plan rather than a distant dream.

Weekends on the doorstep

The Hills, the gulf beaches and four famous wine regions are all within easy reach, so a day out never needs much planning.

A route into Australia

South Australia counts as regional for skilled migration, which can open extra visa pathways. We will talk you through the detail.

GOOD TO KNOW

A close-knit system

Adelaide has fewer tertiary sites than Sydney, Melbourne or Brisbane. If you work in a very narrow sub-specialty, talk to us early and we will map your options together.

Proper summer heat

Summers are dry and hot, with a few runs of very hot days each year. A home with good cooling and an early-morning rhythm make it easy to enjoy.

Elegant rather than enormous

Adelaide is relaxed and village-like. For big-city energy, Melbourne is a short flight away.

Family visits by air

Melbourne and Sydney are a flight rather than a drive, so it is worth budgeting for a few trips east each year.

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An honest word before you decide

Adelaide is one of the most sought-after destinations in Australia, and competition for healthcare roles here is very high. Securing a role, and particularly a sponsored role, is considerably more challenging in Adelaide than in regional Australia. Adelaide's regional status for migration can widen your visa options, but it does not change how many people are applying for each role. We are not saying it's impossible, but we want to be honest with you: it can take longer, and it helps to be flexible. Many clinicians start in a regional city, where demand and sponsorship are often stronger, and move to Adelaide later with Australian experience behind them.

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Weighing up your options?

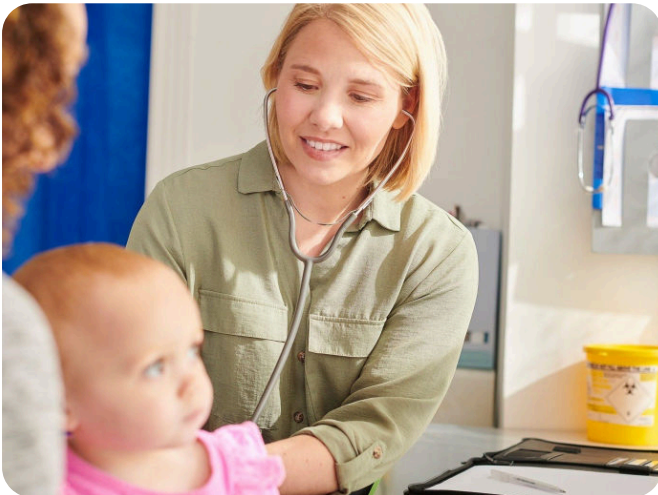
People often compare Adelaide with Melbourne, for scale and sub-specialty depth; Perth, for a similar Mediterranean lifestyle on the west coast; and Brisbane, for warm winters. Adelaide usually offers the shortest commute and the most home for your salary. We are always happy to talk any of them through.



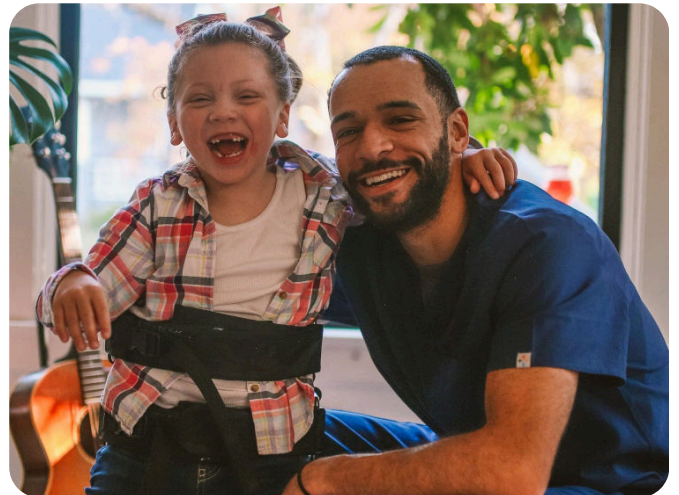
The Adelaide Arcade on Rundle Mall: grand old buildings and an easy, walkable centre



Rundle Mall in the heart of the city, home of the much-loved Mall's Balls sculpture



Gentle care for the youngest patients.



Moments that make the work worthwhile.

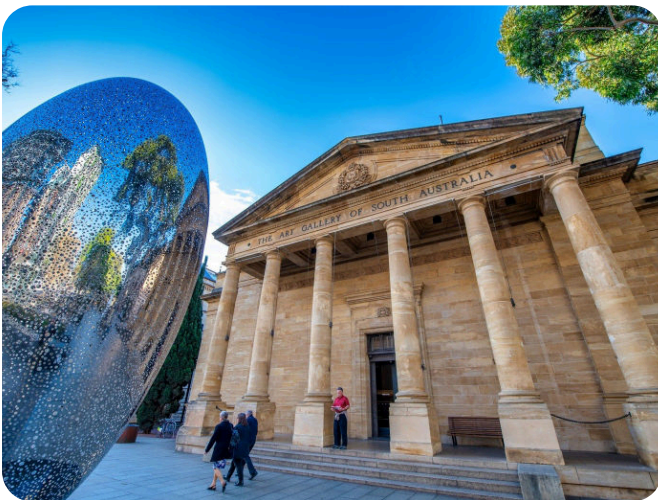
A planned city between the hills and the sea

Adelaide is the easiest Australian capital to find your way around: a grid in the middle, parkland all the way around it, the hills on one side, the gulf on the other, and almost nothing more than half an hour away.

The grid and the parklands. The city centre is a square mile of wide streets and five public squares, wrapped completely by parkland. The Torrens runs through that green belt, and North Terrace, along its northern edge, carries the museum, the art gallery, the state library, the universities and the new health and research precinct.

The coast. Around thirty kilometres of white sand run down the western edge, from North Haven through Henley, Glenelg and Brighton to Seacliff and, further south, Sellicks. Glenelg has the tram; the rest have jetties, esplanades and sunsets over the gulf.

The hills and valleys. Behind the city the Adelaide Hills rise within twenty minutes, cooler and greener, with autumn colour and misty winter mornings. Beyond them, the wine valleys wrap around the capital: the Barossa and Clare to the north, McLaren Vale and the Fleurieu Peninsula to the south.



The Art Gallery of South Australia on North Terrace, the city's cultural boulevard



Jacarandas colour Adelaide's streets purple in late spring

Summer

DEC – FEB

Warm to hot and dry, typically around 17–29°C, with a few runs of very hot days each year that end with a refreshing cool change off the Southern Ocean. Beach evenings and long light.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Golden and settled, around 12–23°C. Mad March fills the city with festivals, and vintage turns the valleys gold. Many locals' favourite season.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Mild, green and fresh, around 8–16°C by day, with most of the year's rain. Log fires in the Hills and footy at the oval.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Bright and blossoming, around 11–22°C, with jacarandas, wildflowers, show season and the first beach days.

Good to know about the climate

- ✓ Adelaide has a Mediterranean climate: dry summers and mild, green winters, with rain mostly from May to September.
- ✓ On the hottest days, locals plan around the heat: early swims, shady parks, plenty of water and a cool home in the afternoon.
- ✓ Make good cooling and heating part of your rental search. A reversible split system keeps you comfortable at both ends of the year.
- ✓ The Hills are a few degrees cooler and the coast enjoys the sea breeze first.



The half-hour clock

South Australia runs on Australian Central Time, thirty minutes behind Sydney and Melbourne, and it does observe daylight saving in summer. National meetings start at odd-looking times and football bounces at half past, but everyone adjusts within a month.



Kaurna Country

Adelaide stands on Kaurna Country. Tarntanya, the Kaurna name for the city centre area, is often translated as 'place of the red kangaroo', and you will see Kaurna names in dual naming across the parklands and city squares. Acknowledgement of Country opens meetings, and health services work in partnership with Aboriginal community-controlled organisations, so a genuine interest in your cultural induction is warmly welcomed.

Healthcare and work in Adelaide

Registration is national; hiring in Adelaide runs through a handful of public networks plus a substantial private sector. The system is large for the city's size and small enough to know by name.

South Australia runs its public health system through ten local health networks. Three of them cover metropolitan Adelaide, broadly the central city, the northern suburbs and the south, and a fourth is a statewide women's and children's service based in the capital. Each network employs in its own right, so the one you join also shapes your campus, your case mix and your commute.

Alongside them sit a substantial private and not-for-profit hospital sector concentrated in Adelaide, a state ambulance service, university-linked research institutes along North Terrace, and Aboriginal community-controlled health organisations. Many Adelaide careers combine public and private work.

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metropolitan health networks

central, northern and southern Adelaide

1

statewide women's and children's service

with outreach across South Australia

1

national register

Ahpra registration works anywhere in Australia



Tertiary and quaternary medicine, in a city where you can live twenty minutes from work

THE NEW PRECINCT

Central Adelaide

A major teaching hospital on the city's western boulevard, beside medical research institutes and university health faculties, with the state's major trauma capacity and its deepest research links.

THE GROWTH CORRIDOR

Northern Adelaide

Where demand has grown fastest, and one of the most consistently open doors for clinicians arriving from overseas.

COASTAL SIDE OF THE CITY

Southern Adelaide

Its own teaching hospital with community and specialist sites around it, and the shortest commute for anyone drawn to the southern beaches.

STATEWIDE SERVICE

Women's and children's

Paediatric and maternity specialist care run as their own network, so a whole career in children's or maternity work is possible with one employer.

What this adds up to is tertiary and quaternary medicine, including trauma, teaching, research and specialist services, in a city where a twenty-minute commute is normal. That combination is rare, and it is the reason so many clinicians choose Adelaide.

Because the system is close-knit, you are known by name quickly, and opportunities often travel through relationships as much as through advertisements. If you work in a very narrow sub-specialty, ask us early: we will map the realistic options with you before you apply.

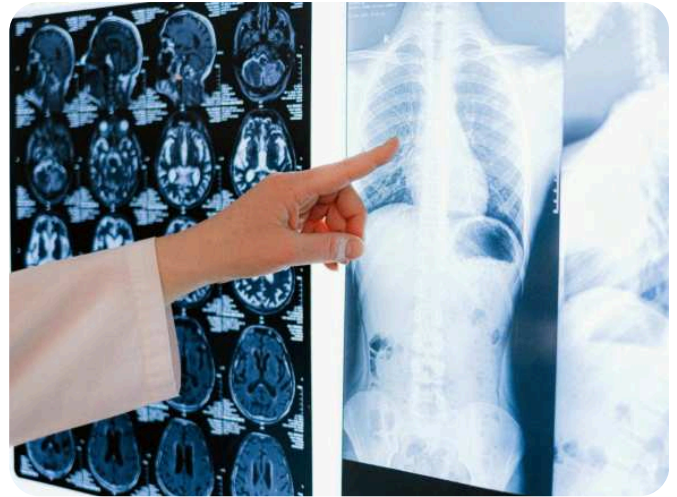
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Regional for migration

The whole of South Australia, Adelaide included, is classed as regional for skilled migration, which can open extra visa pathways and points that the larger eastern capitals do not. Once you have a job offer, this can make the visa side of the move smoother for many internationally trained clinicians. We will always check the current rules with you.



Overseas-trained clinicians are a familiar and valued part of Adelaide's teams



Imaging, allied health and medical roles are spread across public and private services

Giving yourself the best chance in Adelaide

- ✓ Be open to more than one campus, service or shift pattern. The wider your search, the better your chances.
- ✓ Keep a regional option alongside Adelaide. Regional cities often have stronger demand and are more able to sponsor, and Australian experience makes a later move to Adelaide much easier.
- ✓ Get your registration well under way early. Employers here often favour candidates who can start sooner.
- ✓ Talk to us early, so we can give you a realistic picture for your profession and specialty.

What to ask at interview

- ☐ Which network and which campus will I work at, and might I be rostered across sites?
- ☐ What is the roster pattern, including shifts, penalties and on-call, and how are rosters built?
- ☐ How does salary packaging work here, and can I set it up from my first pay?
- ☐ What orientation, supervision and support is there for clinicians new to Australia?
- ☐ What CPD time and funding is offered, and does interstate conference travel count?
- ☐ Are there research links or joint appointments in my area?
- ☐ What does the employer cover for professional indemnity, and what should I hold myself?

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Two things to do early

Start your registration as soon as Adelaide is on your shortlist, because paperwork is what usually sets start dates. And once you arrive, arrange ambulance cover: it is not automatic in South Australia, and a state ambulance membership or an add-on to your health insurance is inexpensive peace of mind.



Care that people remember.



Time to listen.



A warm welcome on the ward.

Where to live in Adelaide

Adelaide is small enough that this decision is forgiving: even if you choose slightly differently next time, you are still around twenty minutes from work. It is one of the more enjoyable housing decisions in Australia.

~5-10 MIN · WALKABLE

North Adelaide & Prospect

Bluestone villas, leafy streets and village high streets across the parklands from the city. Many hospital staff start here, walking or cycling to work.

~10 MIN · CAFÉ STRIPS

Unley & Goodwood

Character cottages and family homes just south of the city, with a lively main street, good schools and an easy ride in.

~10 MIN · THE PARADE

Norwood & the east

Norwood's Parade is one of the city's best-loved village high streets, with cafés, shops and established family suburbs around it.

~25 MIN · BEACH BY TRAM

Glenelg & Brighton

Sand at the end of the tram line, jetty swims before a late start and sunsets over the gulf. A favourite with families and early risers.

~20 MIN · SEASIDE

Henley & Grange

Relaxed beach suburbs to the west, with a square full of cafés by the jetty and a long esplanade for evening walks.

~20-30 MIN · THE HILLS

Stirling, Aldgate & Crafers

Genuine hill country: cooler, greener, autumn colour and misty mornings, with village shops and big gardens.

~35 MIN · HILLS VALUE

Mount Barker

One of the fastest-growing towns in the state, with newer homes, schools and freeway access. More space for your money; bring a car.

~25-45 MIN · NEWER HOMES

The northern & southern corridors

North through Mawson Lakes towards Gawler, and south through Seaford towards Aldinga: newer houses, bigger blocks, rail links and hospital campuses of their own.

As a simple guide: if you would love to walk or ride to work, look at North Adelaide, Prospect and Unley. For beach life on a roster, follow the tram and the coast road from Glenelg to Grange. For space and a garden, the Hills and Mount Barker are lovely; and for a newer family home, the growing northern and southern corridors offer the best value in the metropolitan area.

Most people rent for the first few months while they learn the city, then choose where to settle. Arrive with your references, proof of income and job offer ready as clean PDFs, and you will be well placed in a busy rental market.



The esplanade at Brighton, on Adelaide's metropolitan coast



The Adelaide Hills: vines, villages and gardens twenty to thirty minutes from the city

Before you sign a lease

- ☐ Is the home inside the school zone you need? Zones for popular government schools are set street by street.
- ☐ Does it have good cooling and heating? A reversible split system makes summer and winter comfortable and keeps bills in check.
- ☐ How long is the commute at your actual shift times, and is there parking at both ends?
- ☐ In the Hills, read up on the bushfire season and make a simple household plan, just as locals do.
- ☐ Would a short-term rental first be wiser? Many people re-choose their suburb once they know the city.

Getting around Adelaide

Adelaide’s transport story is mostly about ease: no toll roads anywhere in the state, some of the shortest commutes of any Australian capital, and an airport about fifteen minutes from the city centre.

ADELAIDE METRO
metroCARD
Trains, trams and buses all run on one tap-on card, or simply tap your contactless bank card. Simple, and good value by capital-city standards.

CITY TO GLENELG
The tram
One line, but the right one: free through the city centre, then out to the beach at Glenelg. It makes the coast a commute, not an outing.

SUBURBAN LINES
Trains
Lines reach the coast, the northern growth corridor and the south. A small, friendly network that is genuinely useful if you live near a station.

NORTH-EAST
The O-Bahn
Adelaide’s own guided busway: buses running on a dedicated concrete track to the north-east, one of the quickest suburban rides in the country.

Living car-free is realistic in the inner ring, along the tram corridor and near a train line. In the Hills and the outer corridors, most households plan on a car from the start.

Australians drive on the left, and Adelaide is an easy capital to learn in: a flat grid, ring routes, no tolls and gentle rush hours. You can usually drive on a valid overseas licence for a period after arriving, then transfer to a South Australian licence once you are resident. Once you leave the metropolitan area, distances lengthen, so plan fuel stops and take care with wildlife at dawn and dusk.

FROM THE CITY CENTRE TO	TYPICAL TIME
The inner ring (Norwood, Unley, Prospect)	5–12 min
Adelaide Airport	~15 min
The Adelaide Hills (Stirling)	~20 min
Henley Beach	~20 min
Glenelg	~25 min by tram

FROM THE CITY CENTRE TO	TYPICAL TIME
Mount Barker	~35 min
McLaren Vale	~40 min
The Barossa	~1 hr
Melbourne	~1 hr 15 by air, or a long day's drive



Victoria Square / Tarntanyangga at night, with the city tram gliding past



The River Torrens and its riverside paths, a lovely way to walk or cycle across the city



Good to know

Pick a home near your work or close to a tram or train line and the city does the rest. The hours this gives back each week are one of the most-felt advantages of living in Adelaide.

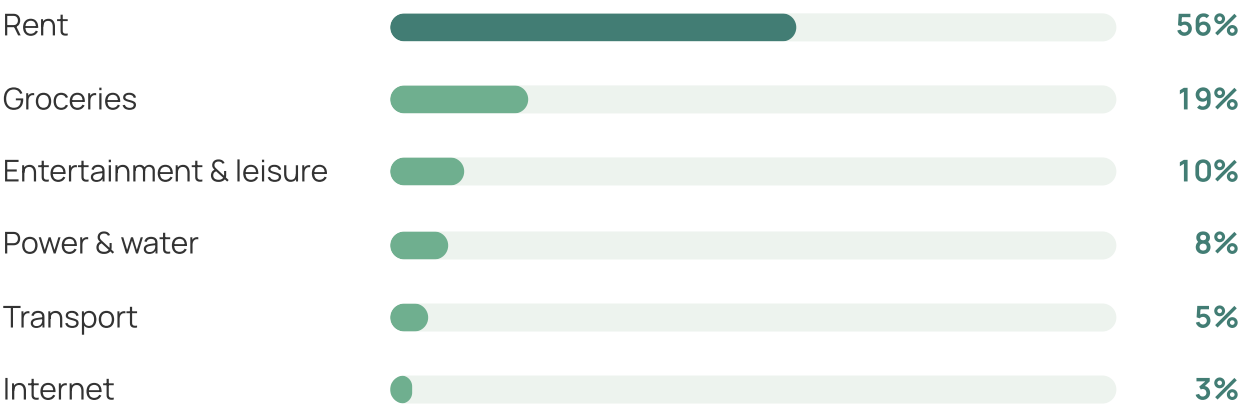
What it costs to live here

Adelaide is the most affordable of the mainland capitals, and it is housing that makes the difference: like-for-like homes cost well below Sydney and Melbourne, so a clinical salary goes a lot further.

Pay in public health follows state agreements and sits broadly in the national range. What changes in Adelaide is what that pay buys. Rent and house prices are noticeably lower than in the larger eastern capitals, which for many households frees up enough each month to cover the grocery bill, and buying a family home becomes a realistic plan.

The small things add up too: no tolls, parking that is reasonable by capital-city standards, commutes short enough to save on childcare hours, the Central Market for great-value produce, and the ten-cent container refund on cans and bottles.

Where a month goes



Proportions for one person on a mid-range budget, not amounts. Rent is the biggest line, and in Adelaide it is among the smallest of the mainland capitals.



Adelaide Central Market, where the weekly shop is often better value than the supermarket

Worth planning for

- ✓ Power. South Australian electricity is among the dearer in the country, so an energy-efficient home and a well-chosen energy plan are well worth the comparison shopping.
- ✓ A car. Inner-city and tram-corridor life can be car-free, but most families run a car; include a reliable used car, registration and insurance in your arrival plans.
- ✓ Flights east. If family or friends are in Sydney, Melbourne or overseas via the east coast, set aside something for a few trips a year.
- ✓ Salary packaging. Public health and not-for-profit roles can package part of your pay before tax. Ask payroll about it on day one.

IN SHORT

- ✓ On a clinical salary, Adelaide is a comfortable place to live and one of the most realistic capitals in which to buy a home.
- ✓ Choose an energy-efficient home and shop around for power.
- ✓ Use Numbeo or the government cost-of-living pages to compare today's prices with the city you are leaving.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Adelaide

What I love most about Adelaide is how much life it offers for the money. Having spent years in the NHS, I know how easily work can take over, and what stands out here is how close everything is. The hills, the sea and the vines are all a short drive away, and people genuinely make time for them.

My advice is to think about your commute, your community and what you will do on your days off. Those things shape your happiness more than people expect, and Adelaide gets all three beautifully right. If you want a capital-city career with a little more breathing space, I will happily tell you to come and look.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



More time for the things that matter: a short commute leaves room for days like this



Weekends away become part of ordinary life

Food, wine and the everyday

Adelaide eats and drinks very well. The Central Market sits at the heart of the city, local supermarkets are a point of pride, and good wine is treated as an everyday pleasure rather than a luxury.

SINCE 1869

Adelaide Central Market

Around seventy stalls of produce, cheese, seafood, bread and world foods under one roof. Thursday evening and early Saturday are the favourite shopping times.

PROUDLY SOUTH AUSTRALIAN

Local supermarkets

Woolworths, Coles and ALDI are everywhere, alongside Drakes and Foodland, the much-loved local chains.

CITY CENTRE

Laneways and small bars

Peel Street, Leigh Street and their neighbours are full of small bars and restaurants, and eating out costs less than in Sydney.

40 MIN – 1 HR

Cellar-door lunches

McLaren Vale, the Hills and the Barossa double as the city's best long lunches, all an easy drive away.

For its size, Adelaide feeds its communities well. The western suburbs carry the city's Italian and Greek heritage, with delis, continental grocers and long Sunday lunches. The north and north-east are the centre for Indian, Asian, African and Middle Eastern groceries, and halal butchers are easy to find there. Kosher supplies are more limited than in Sydney or Melbourne but available through the long-established Jewish community. The Central Market fills most gaps in one visit.

For newcomers, these shops matter beyond the ingredients: they sit alongside the community associations, places of worship and weekend gatherings that help a new city feel like home within a month or two.



Summer fruit at the Central Market



Fresh oysters: South Australian seafood is a highlight of eating out



Flavours of home: Indian and South Asian grocers are easy to find

Local habits worth knowing

- ✓ Bring your bags. South Australia was the first state to phase out lightweight plastic shopping bags, so keep a few in the car.
- ✓ Farmers' markets. Willunga on a Saturday morning is the flagship, and the Hills and the Barossa have their own.
- ✓ Save your bottles. The ten-cent refund on cans and bottles has run since 1977; a crate in the boot and a trip to the depot is a genuine local habit.
- ✓ Try the local favourites at least once: fritz from the deli, a pie floater, and a Farmers Union iced coffee.

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Mad March

Every March the Adelaide Fringe, the Adelaide Festival and WOMAdelaide fill the city with performances, food and open-air gardens. It is the liveliest month of the year and a wonderful introduction to Adelaide if you arrive in late summer.



Weekend brunch is a much-loved ritual, and eating out costs less than in Sydney

What people do at the weekend

Almost everything worth a weekend sits within an hour of Adelaide: up into the Hills, down the coast, or north to the wine valleys. That is why a long cellar-door lunch here is a normal Saturday rather than a special occasion.

A typical Adelaide weekend

- ✓ An early swim or a jetty walk at Henley or Brighton, then fish and chips on the esplanade.
- ✓ A walk to the Mount Lofty summit and the botanic garden below it, or a section of the Heysen Trail.
- ✓ Club sport for every age, and AFL footy at the oval in winter.
- ✓ The Willunga farmers' market on Saturday morning, then an afternoon in McLaren Vale.
- ✓ Hahndorf and the Hills villages for lunch by the fire in winter.
- ✓ In March, one Fringe show, one Festival night and one WOMADelaide afternoon.

~20-25 MIN

The city beaches

Around thirty kilometres of white sand from North Haven to Seacliff, with jetties, esplanades and calm gulf water.

~20 MIN

Mount Lofty & the Hills

City views from the summit, a beautiful botanic garden, walking trails and cool-climate villages.

~30 MIN

Hahndorf

A German-heritage main street in the Hills, with bakeries, galleries and gardens.

~40 MIN

McLaren Vale

Vines running almost to the sea, cellar doors and long lunches, with beaches a few minutes away.

~1 HR

The Barossa

One of the world's best-known wine regions, with bakeries, cellar doors and pretty country towns.

~2 HRS

Clare Valley

The Riesling Trail, a former railway line, makes a lovely day's cycling between cellar doors.



Sunset at Maslin Beach, where the metropolitan coast gives way to the Fleurieu



South Australian vines at sunset: wine country is never far from home



A glass in the vines, a classic Adelaide weekend

○ Mad March

AUTUMN

The Fringe, the Adelaide Festival, WOMADelaide and motorsport, all at once. The city doubles in energy for a month, followed by vintage in the valleys.

○ Winter

JUN – AUG

Illuminate Adelaide lights up the city, the Hills do log fires and galleries, and the footy derby splits every workplace in two.

○ Spring

SEP – NOV

Jacarandas, wildflowers, the show and the first warm beach days.

Around Adelaide

Three roads lead out of Adelaide, and almost everything worth a weekend is on one of them: up into the Hills, down the coast to the Fleurieu, and north to the wine valleys and the outback ranges beyond.

South of the city, the coast road runs past McLaren Vale to the Fleurieu Peninsula's surf beaches and coves, to Victor Harbor and its winter whale-watching season, and to Cape Jervis, where the ferry crosses to Kangaroo Island: wilderness beaches, sea lions, kangaroos and remarkable local food.

North, the Barossa is about an hour away and the Clare Valley about two. Further on, the Flinders Ranges rise from the plains: ancient red mountains, gorges and the great natural amphitheatre of Wilpena Pound, a favourite long-weekend road trip.

For snow, Adelaide families fly to Melbourne, a little over an hour, and drive up to the Victorian Alps, or make a long road trip of it. Many people make a ski holiday an annual winter treat.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Henley Beach & Glenelg	~20–25 min	The nearest beaches: white sand, jetties and calm gulf water, with the tram running to Glenelg.
Victorian Alps ski fields	a short flight to Melbourne, then ~3–4 hrs by road	The nearest snow, from roughly June to September. A winter holiday rather than a day trip.
Melbourne	~1 hr 15 by air, ~8 hrs by road	The nearest other capital: theatre, sport, shopping and family visits.
Adelaide Airport	~15 min	Direct flights to every Australian capital and to international hubs.
Hahndorf & the Adelaide Hills	~20–30 min	Villages, gardens, cellar doors and the Mount Lofty summit.
The Barossa	~1 hr	World-famous wine, bakeries and country towns.
Victor Harbor & the Fleurieu	~1 hr 15	Surf beaches, coastal walks and whales in winter.
Kangaroo Island	~2 hrs to the ferry, or a short flight	Wildlife, wilderness beaches and Remarkable Rocks.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Flinders Ranges	~5 hrs	Ancient ranges, Wilpena Pound and outback skies.

FERRY OR A SHORT FLIGHT

Kangaroo Island

Australia's third-largest island: sea lions, kangaroos and koalas, Remarkable Rocks and some of the country's best local produce. Worth a long weekend.

~1 HR

The Fleurieu Peninsula

Surf beaches, sheltered coves, cliff-top walks and the historic port at Victor Harbor.

~5 HRS

Flinders Ranges

Red rock, river gums and starry skies. A classic South Australian road trip.

~25 MIN BY TRAM

Glenelg

Adelaide's best-known beach suburb, with a jetty, a busy square and summer evenings by the water.



Sellicks Beach, at the southern end of Adelaide's coast



The road into McLaren Vale, forty minutes from the city



Sunrise on the Fleurieu Peninsula, about an hour south



The Flinders Ranges, a favourite long-weekend road trip north of Adelaide



Kangaroos are part of the scenery once you leave the city



The Twelve Apostles on Victoria's Great Ocean Road, a classic road trip towards Melbourne



Melbourne, the nearest other capital, a little over an hour away by air

Families and schools

Adelaide is a lovely place to raise children: short commutes, safe and green suburbs, beaches and parks everywhere, and enough time in the week to actually enjoy them.



After the bell: the school day ends mid-afternoon, leaving time for sport and the beach

South Australian children start school in reception, the year before Year 1. Since 2024 there has been a single intake each year, so children who turn five before 1 May generally start reception at the beginning of that school year. Primary school runs from reception to Year 6 and high school from Year 7 to Year 12, finishing with the South Australian Certificate of Education (SACE). The school year runs across four terms, from late January to mid-December.

Families choose between government schools, Catholic schools and independent schools. Most children go to their local government school; popular government schools have zones set street by street, so check the zone for the exact address before you sign a lease. Catholic and independent schools set their own fees and enrolment processes and often have waiting lists, so it is worth contacting them early.

Long-established government options in and near the city include Adelaide High School and Adelaide Botanic High School, both zoned, alongside many well-regarded schools across the suburbs. Uniforms are usual at almost every school, and are bought through each school's uniform shop.

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School fees for temporary visa holders

South Australia does charge fees for some temporary visa holders' children at government schools. Families on a subclass 482 visa in the greater Adelaide area pay a student contribution fee that is income-tested, with a sibling discount and exemptions for some country schools. Check the Department for Education's page on student fees and enrolment for subclass 482 visa holders, and its 482 visa student fee calculator, before you plan your budget.

Choosing a school

- ☐ Use the Department for Education's school zone maps to check the zone at the exact address before you sign a lease.
- ☐ Contact Catholic and independent schools early; many have waiting lists and enrolment interviews.
- ☐ Ask about English as an additional language support if your children are new to English.
- ☐ Visit or ask for a video call. Adelaide schools are used to welcoming international families.

What children tend to love here

- ☒ The beach, with calm gulf water at Henley, Glenelg and Brighton that is gentle for young swimmers.
- ☒ Adelaide Zoo and the Botanic Garden, both in the city's parklands.
- ☒ Wildlife parks in the Hills, and spotting kangaroos and koalas on trips out of town.
- ☒ Club sport for every age: footy, netball, cricket, soccer, swimming and surf lifesaving nippers.
- ☒ The Fringe's family shows in March and the Christmas Pageant in November.



Preschool and early learning help little ones settle in quickly



Outdoor play is a big part of early learning here



Senior school: clear pathways to university and vocational training

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Early childhood

Children in South Australia can attend a free government preschool (kindergarten) in the year before school, and the state is introducing preschool for three-year-olds in stages. Long day care and out-of-school-hours care are widely available, with the Australian Government's Child Care Subsidy helping eligible families with fees.

CITY CAMPUSES

Adelaide University

The new university formed by bringing together the University of Adelaide and the University of South Australia, including large health and medical faculties.

SOUTHERN ADELAIDE

Flinders University

A research university with a strong reputation in medicine, nursing and health sciences.

VOCATIONAL TRAINING

TAFE SA

The state's vocational college, with campuses across Adelaide and courses from trades to health and community services.

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Adelaide gives you back the hours,
and the weekends to fill them.

Your Adelaide address book

Adelaide is a quietly multicultural city, with long-established Italian and Greek communities and fast-growing Indian, Filipino and African ones. Kerala families are well served, with a Malayalee association, Syro-Malabar Catholic parishes and Malankara Orthodox congregations, and the Multicultural Communities Council of SA brings together more than a hundred community groups.

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City of Adelaide

The city council for the CBD and North Adelaide: libraries, parklands, parking and city events
cityofadelaide.com.au

Local Government Association of SA

Greater Adelaide is made up of many councils; use this to find yours for bins, libraries and pools
lga.sa.gov.au

SA.GOV.AU

The state government's information site, including Service SA for licences and vehicle registration
sa.gov.au

Adelaide Metro

Trains, trams and buses: timetables, journey planner and metroCARD
adelaidemetro.com.au

Consumer and Business Services

Rental bonds, tenancy rights and the free Tenant Advice and Advocacy Service
cbs.sa.gov.au

healthdirect

Free 24-hour health advice from a registered nurse
 1800 022 222 healthdirect.gov.au

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South Australian Tourism Commission

The state's official visitor site: events, food, wine regions and things to do
southaustralia.com

Adelaide Central Market

Opening hours, traders and events at the city's famous food market
adelaidecentralmarket.com.au

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Multicultural Communities Council of SA (MCCSA)

The state's umbrella body for multicultural community groups; a good first contact for finding your community, events and support.
mccsa.org.au

Australian Migrant Resource Centre (AMRC)

Settlement support, community programs and employment help for migrants. 23 Coglin Street, Adelaide.
 08 8217 9500 amrc.org.au

Adult Migrant English Program (AMEP), TAFE SA

Free English classes for eligible migrants and their partners, with flexible and online options.
tafesa.edu.au/english-language-services/adult-migrant-english-program

Indian Australian Association of South Australia (IAASA)

Umbrella Indian community association: Diwali, Republic Day and cultural events across Adelaide.
iaasa.com.au

Adelaide & Metropolitan Malayalee Association (AMMA)

Community association for Kerala families in Adelaide, running the annual Onam celebration and other cultural events.

Adelaide Tamil Association

Tamil community association; listed by the High Commission of India among South Australia's Indian associations.

Telugu Association of South Australia

Telugu community association; listed by the High Commission of India among South Australia's Indian associations.

Filipino Association of South Australia

Founded in 1975 and the state's largest Filipino organisation: cultural, social and seniors' activities.

Filipino Community Council of South Australia

Coordinating body for the state's Filipino organisations, with community forums and events.

Nigerian Association in South Australia (NASA)

Social and cultural events for Nigerian families in Adelaide; based in Prospect.

facebook.com/p/Nigerian-Association-In-South-Australia-100064326684068

African Community Organisation of South Australia

Umbrella group many African communities, including Zimbabwean South Australians, are involved in.

Australia Sri Lanka Association (ASLA)

Sri Lankan community association, known for its annual Sri Lankan food festival and cultural day.

Irish Australian Association (Irish Club)

Music on Friday nights, a free Tuesday social group, Irish language classes and a warm welcome for Irish and UK arrivals. 11 Carrington Street, Adelaide.

08 8212 3767 irishclub.org.au

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Nigerian Association In South Australia

Community page with event dates and notices.

facebook.com/p/Nigerian-Association-In-South-Australia-100064326684068

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St Francis Xavier's Cathedral

The Catholic cathedral on Victoria Square / Tarntanyangga, seat of the Archdiocese of Adelaide; the archdiocese site lists parishes across the city.

adelcath.org.au

St Mary's Syro-Malabar Catholic Parish, Adelaide South

Holy Qurbana in Malayalam at St Therese church, 5 Oxford Circus, Colonel Light Gardens; there are also Adelaide North and Adelaide Central Syro-Malabar communities.

syromalabar.org.au/adelaide-south

St Mary's Jacobite Syriac Orthodox Church

Malankara Jacobite congregation for Kerala families, in Morphet Vale.

stmaryschurchadelaide.org

St Peter's Cathedral

The Anglican cathedral in North Adelaide, with regular services and choral music.

stpeters-cathedral.org.au

Futures Church, Paradise

Large Pentecostal church (formerly Influencers Church) with Sunday services and family programmes. 57 Darley Road, Paradise.

australia.influencers.church/paradise

Cathedral of Archangels Michael and Gabriel

Greek Orthodox cathedral of the Greek Orthodox Community of SA, 286 Franklin Street, Adelaide.

gocsa.org.au

Adelaide Mosque (Central Adelaide Mosque)

Australia's oldest surviving city mosque, on Little Gilbert Street in the city centre.

Shri Ganesha Hindu Temple

Hindu temple run by the Hindu Society of South Australia, in Oaklands Park.

Sikh Society of South Australia Gurdwara

Gurdwara in Glen Osmond; other Adelaide gurdwaras include Guru Nanak Darbar (Allenby Gardens) and Sarbat Khalsa (Prospect).

Phap Hoa Temple

Vietnamese Buddhist temple in Pennington, one of the largest Buddhist temples in Adelaide.

Adelaide Hebrew Congregation

South Australia's Orthodox synagogue, founded in 1848, at 13 Flemington Street, Glenside.

adelaidehebrew.com.au

Chabad of South Australia kosher service

Kosher meat, baked goods, cheese and dry goods ordered in for the community.

chabad.org.au

Woolworths

Full-range supermarkets across Adelaide, with online ordering.

woolworths.com.au

Coles

Full-range supermarkets across Adelaide, with online ordering.

coles.com.au

ALDI

Usually the lowest-cost weekly shop.

aldi.com.au

Foodland

South Australia's own independent supermarket group, known for local produce.

foodland.com.au

Drakes

A family-owned South Australian supermarket chain.

drakes.com.au

Adelaide Central Market

Around seventy stalls of fresh produce, cheese, seafood and world foods in the city centre, trading since 1869.

adelaidecentralmarket.com.au

Willunga Farmers Market

The region's flagship farmers' market, every Saturday morning in Willunga.

willungafarmersmarket.com.au

Adelaide Central Market and Market Arcade

Asian grocers, halal butchery and world foods under one roof in the city centre.

adelaidecentralmarket.com.au

Salam Supermarket

Middle Eastern and South Asian groceries and halal meat, with several stores across Adelaide.

Adam's Halal Butcher and Supermarket

Halal butcher and grocery on Prospect Road.

Jai Shiv Fruit and Veg

Indian groceries and fresh produce in South Plympton.

JL Choice Mart

Asian supermarket in the city centre.

Gaganis Bros

Greek and Mediterranean groceries in Hindmarsh.

The South African Place

South African groceries and favourites in Holden Hill.

Josephine's Asian Grocery

Filipino and Asian groceries in Mount Barker.

Department for Education: school zones

Maps of government school zones and catchment areas, to check before you sign a lease.

education.sa.gov.au

Fees for subclass 482 visa holders

The Department for Education's page on student fees and enrolment for 482 visa holders, with a fee calculator; other temporary visas are covered by its temporary resident pages.

education.sa.gov.au/parents-and-families/enrol-school-or-preschool/families-482-visas/student-fees-enrolment

School uniform shops

Most Adelaide schools sell their uniforms through an on-site uniform shop or a named supplier; ask the school for its uniform list, and look out for second-hand uniform sales.

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realestate.com.au

The largest property site for rentals and sales.

realestate.com.au

Domain

Rentals, sales and suburb profiles.

domain.com.au

Flatmates.com.au

Rooms and share houses, useful for a first few months.

flatmates.com.au

Consumer and Business Services: renting

Rental bonds are lodged with CBS; information on tenancy rights and checking your bond.

cbs.sa.gov.au

Tenant Advice and Advocacy Service (RentRight SA)

Free advice and advocacy for South Australian tenants.

1800 060 462

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Adelaide Metro

Trains, trams and buses, the journey planner, real-time information and metroCARD.

adelaidemetro.com.au

Transferring an overseas licence

Check whether you can transfer your overseas driver's licence to a South Australian one.

sa.gov.au/topics/driving-and-transport/licences/overseas-licence-transfer

The Driver's Handbook

South Australia's road rules, useful before you drive or take a test.

mylicence.sa.gov.au

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Numbeo: Adelaide

Crowd-sourced cost-of-living comparison with the city you are leaving; a useful ballpark.

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Adelaide

Expatistan

A second side-by-side cost comparison, worth running as a sanity check.

expatistan.com

Australian Bureau of Statistics

Official figures on prices and the direction of travel.

abs.gov.au

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Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in Australia you land.

0 8 0 0 5

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time
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Emergency from a mobile

Also connects to emergency services from any mobile phone
112

healthdirect

Free 24/7 health advice from a registered nurse
1800 022 222 [healthdirect.gov.au](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au)

Lifeline

24/7 crisis support and suicide prevention, by phone, text or chat
13 11 14 [lifeline.org.au](https://www.lifeline.org.au)

Poisons Information Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned
13 11 26

Pregnancy, Birth and Baby

Free support for parents from pregnancy to preschool
1800 882 436 [pregnancybirthbaby.org.au](https://www.pregnancybirthbaby.org.au)

Private health insurance complaints

The Commonwealth Ombudsman's free complaints service
1300 737 299 [ombudsman.gov.au](https://www.ombudsman.gov.au)

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Department of Home Affairs

Visas, skilled occupation lists and processing times
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au

ImmiAccount

Lodge and track your visa application online
online.immi.gov.au

Register of migration agents (OMARA)

Check an agent is registered before you pay
mara.gov.au

Ahpra

National registration and the National Boards
1300 419 495 [ahpra.gov.au](https://www.ahpra.gov.au)

Fair Work Ombudsman

Awards, pay rates and your rights at work
13 13 94 [fairwork.gov.au](https://www.fairwork.gov.au)

1 8 0 0 8

Medicare · Services Australia

Enrolment, cards, claims and reciprocal health care agreements
132 011 [servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare](https://www.servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare)

healthdirect service finder

Find a GP, pharmacy, urgent care or hospital near you
[healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services)

privatehealth.gov.au

Compare private health cover independently; run by the Commonwealth Ombudsman
[privatehealth.gov.au](https://www.privatehealth.gov.au)

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NSW school finder

Government schools and catchments in New South Wales
[education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder](https://www.education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder)

Find my school (Victoria)

School zones for any Victorian address
[findmyschool.vic.gov.au](https://www.findmyschool.vic.gov.au)

Find a school (Queensland)

State schools and catchment areas
qld.gov.au/education/schools/find

Find a public school (WA)

Western Australian public schools and local-intake areas
wa.gov.au/service/education-and-training/school-education/find-public-school

School zones (South Australia)

Zone maps for government schools
education.sa.gov.au/parents-and-families/enrol-school-or-preschool/zones-catchments-and-capacity-management/maps-school-zones-enrolment-year

Find your local school (Tasmania)

Intake areas for Tasmanian government schools
decyp.tas.gov.au/learning/find-your-local-school

Priority enrolment areas (ACT)

Find a Canberra public school for your address
act.gov.au/education-and-training/find-a-school-and-enrol

Choose a school (NT)

Urban and remote schools in the Northern Territory
nt.gov.au/learning/primary-and-secondary-students/choose-a-school

Starting Blocks

Compare childcare services and quality ratings near you
startingblocks.gov.au

Child Care Subsidy

Eligibility, rates and how to apply
servicesaustralia.gov.au/child-care-subsidy

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Australian Taxation Office

Apply for your tax file number (TFN), tax and super
[132861 ato.gov.au](http://132861ato.gov.au)

Moneysmart

Free, independent budgeting, super and banking tools
moneysmart.gov.au

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TIS National

Free interpreting by phone, 24/7, in 150+ languages
[131450 tisnational.gov.au](http://131450tisnational.gov.au)

Settle in Australia

Home Affairs' settlement topics and services for new arrivals
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/settling-in-australia

MyAus app

Government app to help newcomers find services, in many languages
myausapp.com

Overseas drivers (Austroads)

How overseas licences are recognised, with links to each state's licensing authority
austroads.gov.au/drivers-and-vehicles/overseas-drivers/country-recognition



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not registered migration agents.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to Ahpra registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

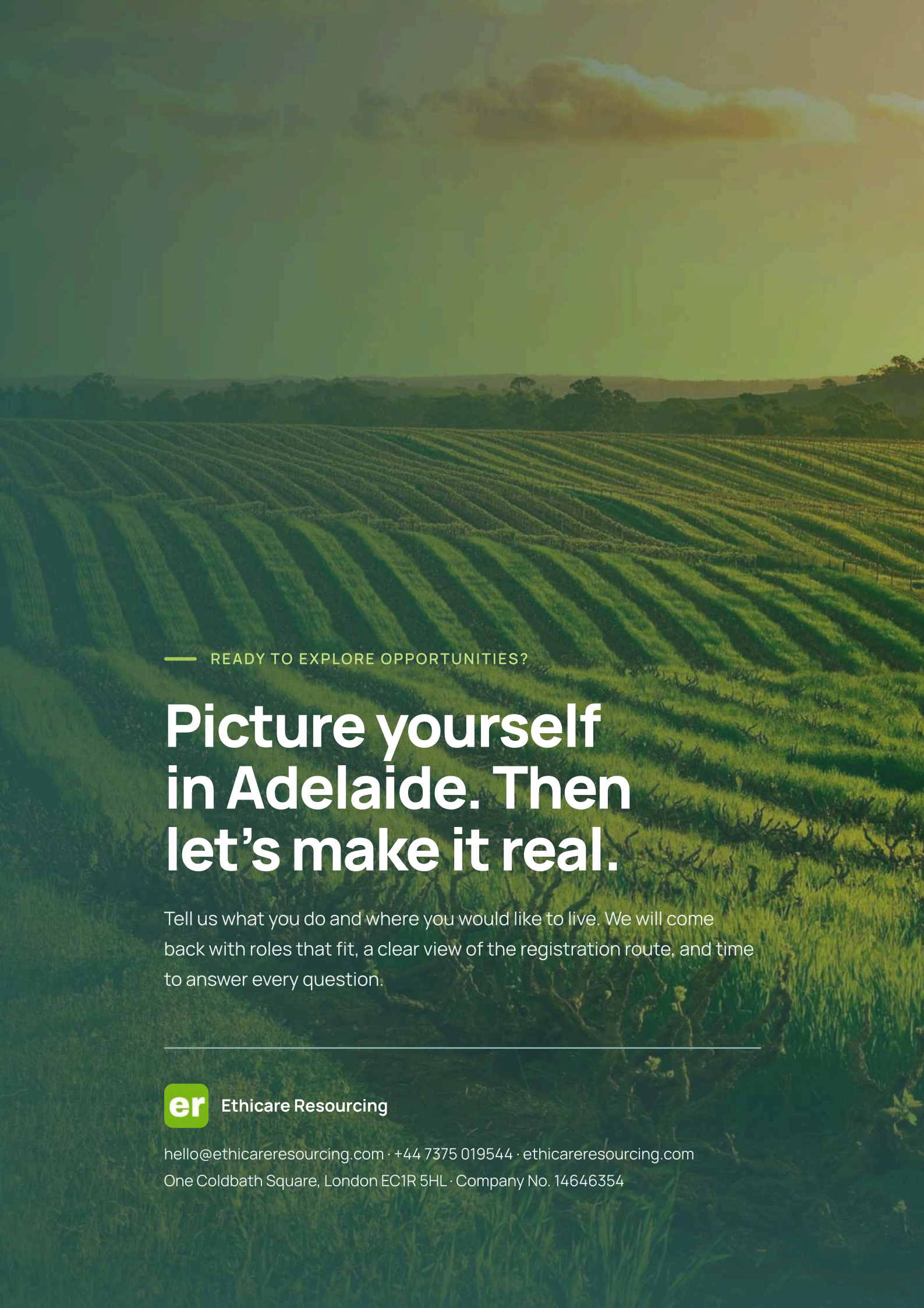
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Adelaide. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, a clear view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

hello@ethicareresourcing.com · +44 7375 019544 · ethicareresourcing.com

One Coldbath Square, London EC1R 5HL · Company No. 14646354